Holden M. Rasmussen, PhD

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Areas of Specialisation

Nineteenth- and twentieth-century European philosophy (especially the French tradition); philosophy and psychoanalysis; social and political philosophy (especially critical theory and postcolonial theory)

Areas of Competence

Moral philosophy; epistemology and metaphysics; aesthetics; existentialism and phenomenology; Plato, Aristotle, and their interpretation in the Medieval World; early modern philosophy and the Enlightenment; Kant and post-Kantian idealisms and materialisms

Languages

- English (native)
- French (advanced)
- Arabic (basic)

Education

PhD, Philosophy, Newcastle University, December 2025
- Dissertation: "Thresholds of Psychoanalysis and Inner Experience: The Ontology of Limit and Relation after Bataille and Lacan"
- Supervisors: Lorenzo Chiesa and Adam Potts

MA, Continental Philosophy, University of Warwick, 2019, with Distinction
- Dissertation: "In Knots for Naught: The Opacity of Desire in Michel Foucault and Jacques Lacan"
- Supervisor: Miguel de Beistegui

BS, Philosophy, Westminster University (Salt Lake City), 2018, with Honors (Westminster Honors College)
- Thesis: "Discontent with Humanism: A Subject for Postmodern Philosophy"
- Advisor: Kara Barnette

Publications

Monograph

Monograph arising from the dissertation, commissioned by Anthem Press for the series *Freudian and Lacanian Psychoanalysis and Philosophy* (series title provisional).

Journal Articles

"'We Are Us but Not Quite': Frantz Fanon's Transvaluation of Group Psychology." *Psychoanalysis, Culture & Society* (2026). https://doi.org/10.1057/s41282-026-00637-1

"Another Body, Another Fantasy: Ambivalence, Drive, and the Letter in Freud's 'A Child Is Being Beaten.'" *Filozofski vestnik* 46, no. 3 (2025).

"Georges Bataille between General Economy and General Psychology." *Problemi* (2024). Translated into Slovenian by Tadej Troha as "Georges Bataille na robovih obče ekonomije in obče psihologije," introducing the first Slovenian translations of essays by Georges Bataille.

"Dialectic of the Limit: Knowledge, Truth, Thinking, and Being after Bataille and Lacan." *Filozofski vestnik* 44, no. 3 (2023). https://doi.org/10.3986/fv.44.3.02

Translations

Jacques Nassif, "Fantasy in 'A Child Is Being Beaten'" and "Freud and Science." First English translations. *Filozofski vestnik* 46, no. 3 (2025).

Editorial Work

Co-editor, with Tadej Troha, special section on Jacques Nassif and the return to Freud, *Filozofski vestnik* 46, no. 3 (2025).

Book Reviews

Review of *Pleasure Erased: The Clitoris Unthought*, by Catherine Malabou. *Hypatia* 39, no. 2 (2024). https://doi.org/10.1017/hyp.2023.89

"The Limits and Gifts of Psychoanalysis." Review essay on *On Freud*, by Elvio Fachinelli. *European Journal of Psychoanalysis* (2022).

Teaching Experience

Guest Lecturer, Institute of Philosophy, ZRC SAZU (Ljubljana), October 2026–January 2027 (present role, invited lecture and seminar series)

- Design and delivery of Series, Group, Colony: The Concrete Universal in Sartre and Fanon, an eight-week graduate course of paired lectures and seminars on group formation

in Sartre's *Critique of Dialectical Reason* and Fanon's *The Wretched of the Earth*, at the invitation of Professor Alenka Zupančič and Dr Tadej Troha.

Tutor, Durham University, October 2026–December 2026 (present role, fixed-term, part-time)

- Tutorial convenor and designer for The Philosophical Traditions (PHIL1091), a first-year introductory course on a range of philosophical approaches. The module also introduces the practice of researching and writing philosophy by examining how philosophers shape knowledge in particular areas.
- Marker for formative assessments of student's writing and research skills in philosophy.

Lecturer in Philosophy, Newcastle University, January–July 2026 (fixed-term, full-time, covering maternity leave)

- Module leader, Introduction to Moral Philosophy (PHI1011), a first-year lecture course of about ninety students: designed the course handbook, lectured, set and marked assessments, and managed the course website
- Module leader and adviser, first- and second-year research project courses (PHI1004, PHI2004): research supervision and academic advising for 28 students
- Module leader, Project Presentations (PHI3023), the final-year capstone: designed and taught skills workshops and set assessments for students organising and presenting at an undergraduate research conference
- Designed and taught courses for the PARTNERS Academic Summer School, Newcastle University's widening-participation programme for students from underrepresented backgrounds (2026)
- Introduced live oral examinations in PHI2004 and PHI3023

Visiting Researcher, Institute of Philosophy, ZRC SAZU, Ljubljana, Autumn 2023

- Gave a lecture and seminar series to graduate students, postdoctoral researchers, and senior scholars working in theoretical psychoanalysis and philosophy

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Newcastle University, 2021–2025 (flexible contract, part-time)

- Taught seminars and marked assessments in early modern metaphysics, epistemology, political philosophy, existentialism, and contemporary aesthetics
- Designed, taught, and assessed a course on politics and aesthetics for the PARTNERS Academic Summer School (2022)

Adjunct Instructor, Department of Philosophy, Westminster University (Salt Lake City), 2020–21 (fixed-term, part-time)

- Designed and taught "Philosophy, Identity, and Self" and "Ethics of Diversity"

Teaching Training and Development

Fellowship in the United Kingdom Higher Education Academy, application under review, acceptance expected in October 2026

- Fellowship in the UKHEA represents institutional recognition of one's ability to design accessible and innovative curricula, reflect and develop teaching practice in dialogue with peers, and provide professional service to HE institutions.

Introduction to Learning and Teaching in Higher Education, Newcastle University, Learning and Teaching Development Service course, autumn 2022

- A learning and teaching course designed to enrich and develop the pedagogical practices of early-career higher education professionals, involving assessment design and grading exercises and peer-to-peer dialogue and reflection.

Grants and Awards

Northern Bridge Doctoral Training Programme Research Award, Arts & Humanities Research Council (UK), 2021–2025

- Funding for tuition and living expenses for part of the doctoral programme at Newcastle University

Arts & Humanities Research Council Large Grant, 2023

- A bursary for funded doctoral students to undertake activities that enhance their doctoral training; funded the visiting researcher placement at ZRC SAZU, Ljubljana, October–December 2023

Arts & Humanities Research Council Small Grants, 2021–2024

- Several awards for training and event organisation during doctoral study (about £1,000 in total)

Fulbright Finalist, US–UK Partner Award to the University of Warwick, 2018–19

Selected Presentations

"A Collective Scream: The Invocatory Dimension of Colonial Suffering Recorded in Frantz Fanon's *The Wretched of the Earth*." Roundtable, Amsterdam Psycho-Politics Workshop, University of Amsterdam, June 2026.

"Another Body, Another Fantasy: From Perversions through Fantasy to Psychosexuality." To Be Continued?...: Philosophy and Psychoanalysis, Part III, ZRC SAZU, Ljubljana, April 2025. https://youtu.be/Mi8kwYXB9Jk

"'We Are Us but Not Quite': Frantz Fanon and the Transvaluation of Group Psychology." The Unconscious in the Wake of Frantz Fanon and Édouard Glissant: A Symposium, Newcastle University, October 2024.

"On Writing, Psychosis, and Relation." To Be Continued?...: Philosophy and Psychoanalysis, Part II, ZRC SAZU, Ljubljana, April 2024. https://youtu.be/s12sNnLSG7c

"The Sound of Death Philosophy: Lacan, Bataille, and Anxiety." Society for European Philosophy Conference, Newcastle University, September 2022.

"The Signs of Logic: The Philosophical Challenge Posed by Stéphane Mallarmé's *Un coup de dés*." Centre for Nineteenth Century Studies Interdisciplinary PGR Conference, Durham University, March 2022.

Service

Department and University

- Learning and Teaching Committee, Boards of Studies, and Board of Examiners, Department of Philosophy, Newcastle University, 2026
- Board of Assessors, PARTNERS Academic Summer School (widening participation), Newcastle University
- Graduate student representative, Faculty–Postgraduate Research Committee, Department of Philosophy, Newcastle University, 2021–22
- Graduate student representative, Welfare and Equality Committee, Department of Philosophy, University of Warwick, 2018–19
- Graduate student representative, Student–Staff Liaison Committee, Department of Philosophy, University of Warwick, 2018–19

Conference Organisation

- Kafka Encapsulated: Form, Matter, and Method, a colloquium in commemoration of the centenary of Franz Kafka's death, November 2024
- Symposium on the Unconscious, Colonialism, Political Philosophy, and the Works of Frantz Fanon and Édouard Glissant, Newcastle University, October 2024
- To Be Continued?...: Philosophy and Psychoanalysis Today, Part II, international conference, ZRC SAZU, Ljubljana, April 2024
- Warwick Continental Philosophy Conference, University of Warwick, May 2019

Civic Engagement

- Decarcerate Utah, January 2020–August 2021
- Students for Choice, October 2014–June 2018
- Scouts of America, rank of Eagle Scout awarded in 2013